

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTONDECLASSIFIED
PER E.O. 135262009-0646-MR
SS 3/15/12

MEMORANDUM OF CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Meeting with President Mitterrand of France
(U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
James A. Baker, Secretary of State
Samuel Skinner, Chief of Staff
Brent Scowcroft, Assistant to the President
for National Security Affairs
Marlin Fitzwater, Assistant to the President
and Press Secretary
David Gompert, Special Assistant to the
President and Senior Director for European
and Eurasian Affairs (Notetaker)
Alec Toumayan, Interpreter

Francois Mitterrand, President of France
Roland Dumas, Minister of State for Foreign
Affairs
Jacques Andreani, Ambassador to the United
States
Pierre Morel, Diplomatic Adviser to the
President
Interpreter

DATE, TIME January 31, 1992, 9:00 a.m. to 9:30 a.m. EST
AND PLACE: Waldorf Towers, New York

President Mitterrand: We really need an opportunity to meet and talk at length. (Ø)

The President: I could not agree more. I know I owe you an answer to a letter you sent me back in December. My answer is yes. We are prepared to go forward with what you propose. We've taken while to answer the letter because Jim has been working with the Germans. But proceed on this. Let's just be sure it does not appear to an outsider to be the creation of some exclusive club. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: My proposal makes it clear, it has a very specific focus only on the dissolution of the Soviet Union. It is not a disarmament forum; that's for the United States and Russia. So there can be no confusion about this. If the Germans and the Italians want to challenge us, perhaps they should get a few nuclear weapons. Baker and Dumas can work out the details. (Ø)

The President: We will treat Yeltsin with respect. (U)

President Mitterrand: We expect Russia to have influence over the other Republics. I think this is important for a stable situation. (C)

The President: At the same time, we have to respect the sovereignty of all the new states. But I agree Russia is key. Jim will soon be making a trip to the "outer six," as we call them where he will press them to accept CFE principles. (C)

Secretary Baker: It is very important that all of us in the West work together to counter Iranian influence in the Central Asian Republics. It is important that we welcome them into our community. The Iranians are very active already. (C)

President Mitterrand: This is quite right. We can also help Yeltsin deal with these other Republics. (C)

The President: I would like to raise the Uruguay Round. This is not the place to discuss the details, but it seems to me we just have to work it out. If we don't, it will be a real blow to world trade. And we'll see trading blocs form. As far as I can see, we haven't really made any progress since I was in The Hague. (U)

President Mitterrand: We should work together on some principles. If we can agree on principles it will be easier for the details to be worked out by experts. The issue of agriculture must be settled, but also there are three or four other areas that have to be settled. (U)

The President: That's right -- services, intellectual property, and market access. (U)

President Mitterrand: I believe this whole thing can be settled in a week. But we have the feeling that the EC is being asked for major sacrifices. Sacrifices should be equal on both sides. (U)

The President: I don't think I could disagree with that. (U)

President Mitterrand: Then, a neutral body could easily work out what that means. (U)

The President: We thought that Dunkel was neutral and objective. (U)

President Mitterrand: Dunkel is just the mouse. The U.S. is the big cat. (laughter) (U)

The President: I want to make clear that I do not want any strains in our bilateral relations. (C)

President Mitterrand: My intention is exactly the same.

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It seems that on very serious issues we get along just fine. But that on secondary issues we have problems. Let's try to meet before this summer, Mr. President. (Ø)

The President: We'll see what's possible. (U)

On Haiti, you should be aware that we are facing an almost impossible situation. We are becoming a magnet for the brigands that are bringing all these poor people to our shores. Now we've reached an impasse. (Ø)

Secretary Baker: We have 14,000 people in a camp at Guantanamo Bay. (U)

The President: If we say O.K., come to Miami, we will open the door to another wave of Cuban refugees. (Ø)

Secretary Baker: C.A.P. (Carlos Andres Perez) will be discussing these ideas with you. Our basic idea is that France, Venezuela, Canada, and the United States should work out a plan. Are there any French speaking territories in the Western hemisphere that could absorb some of these people? C.A.P. will want to talk to you about that. He will also want to inquire about the exiles in your embassy. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: I know in Guiana we have a lot of exiles already. So, I'm not sure what we can do. But we will not close the door on your request. (Ø)

The President: Aristide is O.K., but a weak reed. The embargo isn't working. (Ø)

President Mitterrand: The Haitian people must not become the victim of this. (Ø)

The President: Let me ask you about Algeria, what can be done about that? (U)

President Mitterrand: The fundamentalists there were going to win the election. Then democracy could die. They've organized to win the election, so a democratic event will end in the death of democracy. One has to be pragmatic, we are still in relations with the Algerian government. We'll help them but not be too loud about it. (Ø)

Secretary Baker: We are pleased we are in agreement on Pan Am 103. (U)

President Mitterrand: We'll walk in lock step. We sometimes have to be cautious about North Africa, but on this issue there can be no hesitation. (Ø)

- End of Conversation -

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

February 5, 1992

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

FROM:

ED A. HEWETT

SUBJECT:

Meeting with Lady Caroline Cox, 10:45-11:15am,
February 6, 1992

You will be meeting with Lady Caroline Cox, Deputy Speaker of the House of Lords, U.K. Lady Caroline is highly respected in England for her persistent, and courageous, efforts to call attention to the tragic situation in Nagorno-Karabakh. She meets regularly with British ministers, including Douglas Hurd, to report on her frequent -- and sometimes quite perilous -- trips to the region.

Lady Caroline is here to inform you about the situation. She is accompanied by Zori Balayan, an Armenian, a medical doctor, and member of Nagorno-Karabakh's parliament. Aside from listening, you can report that the U.S. has been active in encouraging both sides to work towards a peaceful resolution of this tragic conflict. Although we know the violence has escalated in the last few weeks, our Moscow Embassy is not sure whether this is a new phase in the war. We are discussing with the British Embassy the possibility of a CSCE Rapporteur Mission to further explore the issue, and to explore possibilities for reducing current tensions.

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20508

February 4, 1992

INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: DAVID C. GOMPERT

FROM: ROBERT L. HUTCHINGS

SUBJECT: Your Meeting with Ambassador (to Yugoslavia)
Warren Zimmermann, February 5, 10:00 a.m.

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 12/11/25

Zimmermann, who will be meeting with Vance in New York on February 6, will want to give you his views on the prospects for UN peacekeeping -- including the chances of bringing Serbian Krajina leader Babic on board, the attitudes of Milosevic and Tudjman, and the course Zimmermann recommends for U.S. policy. He will also want to discuss the Bosnian dilemma, Macedonia, and the future of the rump Yugoslavia.

We recommend that you sound him out on the recognition issue, along the lines of our February 1 memorandum (copy attached). Specifically, we would like to know his reaction to our moving within the next week or two to implement a series of steps:

- consult with the EC and others on our intentions,
- announce our willingness to proceed toward recognition and (as a separate matter) diplomatic relations,
- contact Yugoslav republics and decide (in consultation with the EC) which meet our criteria for recognition and which also qualify for diplomatic relations.

We would expect this approach to lead us to recognize both Slovenia and Croatia fairly quickly, though we would not extend diplomatic relations to Croatia until our criteria (support for the Vance and Carrington missions, guarantees for minority rights, etc.) were met. On Macedonia and Bosnia, we would be prepared to follow the same path but would not move in advance of the EC.

Attachment

Tab I Our February 1 memo on Recognition Policy

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

Declassify on: OADR

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

February 1, 1992

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH:

DAVID C. GOMPERT

FROM:

JANE E. HOLLI

SUBJECT:

Yugoslavia: Recognition Policy

DECLASSIFIED

PER NSC WAIVER 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 12/11/25

Though serious stumbling blocks remain to the deployment of UN peacekeeping forces to the region, the current cease-fire represents the best opportunity, to date, to bring greater stability to the situation in Yugoslavia. This may be the time to begin a process toward recognizing the republics.

Proceeding with recognition has a certain risk: if a UN peacekeeping mission does not materialize -- because of Babic's intransigence or Tudjman's withdrawal of support -- and the cease-fire breaks down, a change now in our policy could be cited (rightly or wrongly) to have been the cause of renewed violence. Nevertheless, if the situation takes a turn for the worse, we could face intense domestic pressure to recognize Slovenia and Croatia. Thus, while the cease-fire continues to hold and as the EC considers its next moves regarding Macedonia and Bosnia, there might not be a better time to begin a shift in our recognition policy.

The idea would not be to recognize the Yugoslav republics immediately, but rather to issue a statement that announces our intent to recognize and outlines our plan for proceeding. A draft statement is at Tab A. Its main points:

- We announce our willingness to proceed with recognition of the Yugoslav republics. The extension of diplomatic relations will follow recognition, but only provided certain conditions are met.
- Our policy on recognition is consistent with international law. We will discuss the extension of recognition with those republics whose people have expressed clearly, democratically and peacefully, a will to be independent. (Note: we have already received requests for recognition from all of the republics except Montenegro and Serbia.)

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

Declassify on: OADR

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

- Following recognition, we will discuss establishing diplomatic relations with the republics. Diplomatic relations will be based on the principles set forth in by Secretary Baker in Moscow. Moreover, we will insist that the republics demonstrate respect for all existing borders and accept the obligation to provide for the protection of human rights. Establishment of full diplomatic relations will also depend on whether the republics respect the current cease-fire and negotiate their new status and relationship in good-faith.
- We intend to apply these criteria and policies to all of the republics. Ambassador Zimmerman will be in Washington for consultations next week at which time we can instruct him to approach the capitals of all six republics for discussions.

The strategy then, has two parts -- recognition followed by diplomatic relations. We would use the establishment of diplomatic relations as leverage on the republics to maintain the cease-fire and cooperate in the peace process. Thus, we might or might not want to establish diplomatic relations with the individual republics depending on whether they make the general commitments we have outlined and abide by the cease-fire.

If we proceed down this path, we could be in a position of recognizing Slovenia, Croatia and Macedonia as early as next week. With Bosnia's referendum scheduled for the end of this month, we have more time, but could conceivably recognize them by the first week in March. We will have a problem with the Greeks (and Greek-Americans) on Macedonia. We can soften the blow of our recognition with a three-fold strategy: do not act before the EC does, consult with the Greeks before we recognize, and frame our declaration of recognition in terms that reaffirm the inviolability of Greece's borders.

With respect to both Macedonia and Bosnia, we would be better off moving with the EC, but we do not know their intentions. We expect that they will discuss these republics at their ministerial on February 4, but they will likely not make any decisions. It may be useful to approach the EC after this meeting but before we issue our statement to coordinate our policies.

In sum, the strategy outlined above does not mean we must recognize the republics immediately, but it does give us the flexibility regarding timing which we may need, especially with Macedonia and Bosnia-Herzegovina.

We have been working with the State Department to develop this strategy. At this stage, we do not have complete agreement (nor does there appear to be department consensus) on whether now is the right time to proceed, which republics to recognize, or the sequence for implementation.

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RECOMMENDATION

That you discuss this strategy and whether to approach the EC with Baker or Eagleburger directly with an eye toward advancing a policy recommendation to the President.

Approve _____ Disapprove _____

Attachment
Tab A Draft Policy Statement

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

The United States has joined a consensus to grant the Republics of Slovenia and Croatia observer status in the Conference on Security and Cooperation in Europe. While this decision was taken without prejudice to U.S. views on the status of these or other republics, it obviously reflects the profound change that has occurred in Yugoslavia as we have known it.

U.S. policy on the recognition of individual Yugoslav republics is based on international law. The peoples of the republics of Yugoslavia have the right to decide their own fate in peace and in ways that are consistent with the principles of the Helsinki Final Act. If and as the people of the republics express clearly, democratically, and peacefully a will to be independent, the U.S. will discuss with the governments of these republics the extension of recognition. U.S. recognition will be without prejudice to any future relationship the republics may choose to negotiate among themselves.

Once a republic is recognized, the United States will then be prepared to enter into discussions regarding diplomatic relations. The establishment of diplomatic relations will be based on the principles set forth in September 1991 by Secretary Baker in Moscow and will depend on whether the republics demonstrate respect for all existing borders and acceptance of the obligation to provide for the protection and equal rights of all individuals, whatever their nationality, as emphasized in the Helsinki Final Act.

In view of the tragic violence that has raged within and between republics, the U.S. wishes further to make clear that any

Republic interested in diplomatic relations must refrain from actions which could jeopardize the peace or undermine the role of the UN and the EC in bringing about a lasting solution.

Secretary Baker has instructed Ambassador Zimmerman [or special envoy, e.g. Niles] to outline to the leadership of all the republics of Yugoslavia our willingness to extend recognition and to establish diplomatic relations based on these principles and guidelines.

Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
14. Memorandum	To: Brent Scowcroft From: Tony Wayne Re: Your Meeting (3 pp.)	2/4/92	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1992 [4]

Date Closed: 6/30/2011	OA/ID Number: 30523-006
FOIA/SYS Case #: 2011-0002-F	Appeal Case #:
Re-review Case #:	Appeal Disposition:
P-2/P-5 Review Case #:	Disposition Date:
AR Case #:	MR Case #:
AR Disposition:	MR Disposition:
AR Disposition Date:	MR Disposition Date:

RESTRICTION CODES

Presidential Records Act - [44 U.S.C. 2204(a)]

P-1 National Security Classified Information [(a)(1) of the PRA]
P-2 Relating to the appointment to Federal office [(a)(2) of the PRA]
P-3 Release would violate a Federal statute [(a)(3) of the PRA]
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P-6 Release would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy [(a)(6) of the PRA]

C. Closed in accordance with restrictions contained in donor's deed of gift.

PRM. Removed as a personal record misfile.

Freedom of Information Act - [5 U.S.C. 552(b)]

(b)(1) National security classified information [(b)(1) of the FOIA]
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(b)(9) Release would disclose geological or geophysical information

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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

February 3, 1992

ACTION

MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT

THROUGH: DAVID C. GOMPERT *mg*

FROM: ROBERT L. HUTCHINGS *RLH*

SUBJECT: Schedule Proposal for Bulgarian Prime Minister
Filip Dimitrov, March 1992

Newly elected Prime Minister Dimitrov will be in Washington the first week of March on a private visit. As Dimitrov had already been approved on the President's schedule for a private visit in June, we concur with State's recommendation that we take advantage of this earlier visit to schedule a 20-30 minute Oval Office meeting (in lieu of a June visit).

Dimitrov, whom I met in Sofia shortly after his election last November, is a committed democrat and market reformer. He wants Bulgaria to become a force for stability in the Balkans, as well as a reliable friend of the U.S. However, the economic disaster he inherited, combined with the spillover of ethnic conflict from Yugoslavia, will sorely test the new, inexperienced Bulgarian Government. A meeting with the President would give a needed boost to the (now ascendant) pro-democracy forces in Bulgaria as Dimitrov launches a difficult program of economic transformation.

RECOMMENDATION

That you sign the Schedule Proposal at Tab I.

Attachments

Tab I Schedule Proposal

Tab A List of Participants

Tab II State Department Recommendation

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 12/11/85

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Declassify on: OADR

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~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

0320

THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

SCHEDULE PROPOSAL

TO: KATHERINE SUPER, Deputy Assistant to the President for Appointments and Scheduling

FROM: BRENT SCOWCROFT

REQUEST: Meeting with Prime Minister Filip Dimitrov of Bulgaria

PURPOSE: To shore up the first wholly democratic government in Bulgaria since World War II and to reinforce its stabilizing policies toward its Balkan neighbors.

BACKGROUND: Prime Minister Dimitrov will come to Washington during the first week of March. As Dimitrov is already on the President's long-range calendar for a private visit in June, this visit would supplant that one. His early arrival comes at an opportune time to promote Bulgaria's democratic development, courageous market reforms, and stabilizing influence in the volatile Balkan region.

PREVIOUS PARTICIPATION: None

DATE & TIME: March 3-5, 1992
DURATION: 20-30 minutes

LOCATION: Oval Office

PARTICIPANTS: See list at Tab A

OUTLINE OF EVENTS: Photo opportunity and meeting

REMARKS REQUIRED: To be provided by NSC.

MEDIA COVERAGE: Open photo, writing pool.

RECOMMENDED BY: State and NSC

OPPOSED BY: None

Attachments
Tab A List of Participants

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Declassify on: OADR

DECLASSIFIED
PER NSC WAIVER 1500 2021-02
By SS NARA, Date 12/11/25

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PARTICIPANTS

U.S.

The President
The Vice President
James A. Baker III, Secretary of State
Samuel Skinner, Chief of Staff
Brent Scowcroft, Assistant to the President
for National Security Affairs
Thomas Niles, Assistant Secretary of State
for European and Canadian Affairs
Robert L. Hutchings, Director for European Affairs, NSC Staff
Interpreter

Bulgaria

Filip Dimitrov, Prime Minister
Ognyan Pishev, Ambassador to the United States
Interpreter
Others TBD



~~CONFIDENTIAL~~
DECL:OADR

January 15, 1992

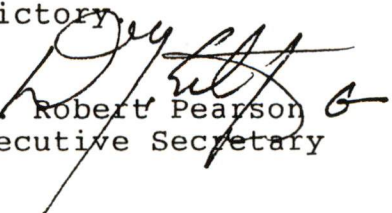
MEMORANDUM FOR BRENT SCOWCROFT
THE WHITE HOUSE

Subject: Presidential meeting with Bulgarian PM Filip Dimitrov

The Department requests that the President meet with Bulgarian Prime Minister Dimitrov for 30 minutes sometime in the first week of March, during a private visit Dimitrov is planning at the invitation of the International Republican Institute (formerly NRI).

Once the USSR's closest ally, Bulgaria now has one of the most enlightened democratic governments among the ex-Communist states. Its policies of ethnic tolerance, rapprochement with former adversary Turkey, and restraint toward Macedonia are helping shore up the region against spillover from Yugoslavia's civil war. It has borne sizable risks to forge ahead with an active program of market reforms and economic stabilization. In the past year it has been a steadfast supporter of U.S. policies, with little regard for the substantial economic costs: among them the losses of \$1.5 billion in trade and production from the impact of the Gulf crisis and \$1.5 billion more in suspended Iraqi and Libyan debt repayments.

Prime Minister Dimitrov heads Bulgaria's first wholly non-communist government since World War II. He also has close ties with the International Republican Institute, whose U.S. Government-funded democracy-building programs played a major role in the democratic forces' electoral successes, culminating in their October 1991 parliamentary victory.


W. Robert Pearson
Executive Secretary

Attachments:
Biographic information

DECLASSIFIED
PER DOS WAIVER, November 6, 2015
By SS NARA, Date 12/11/85

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
15d. Report	Government Report (1 pp.)	10/9/91	(b)(1)	C

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1992 [4]

Date Closed: 6/30/2011	OA/ID Number: 30523-006
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PRM. Removed as a personal record misfile.

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
16a. Memorandum	To: Brent Scowcroft From: Tony Wayne/Nick Burns Re: Message to Mitterrand (1 pp.)	2/4/92	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1992 [4]

Date Closed: 6/30/2011	OA/ID Number: 30523-006
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Document No. and Type	Subject/Title of Document	Date	Restriction	Class.
16b. Memorandum	To: President Bush From: Brent Scowcroft Re: Message to Mitterrand (1 pp.)	n.d.	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1992 [4]

Date Closed: 6/30/2011	OA/ID Number: 30523-006
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Presidential Records Act - [44 U.S.C. 2204(a)]

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Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

(George Bush Library)

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16c. Letter	To: President Mitterrand From: President Bush Re: Camp David Meeting with Yeltsin (2 pp.)	n.d.	(b)(1)	S

Collection:

Record Group: Bush Presidential Records
Office: National Security Council
Series: European / Eurasian Directorate Central Chron File
Subseries:
WHORM Cat.:
File Location: February 1992 [4]

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P-2 Relating to the appointment to Federal office [(a)(2) of the PRA]
P-3 Release would violate a Federal statute [(a)(3) of the PRA]
P-4 Release would disclose trade secrets or confidential commercial or financial information [(a)(4) of the PRA]
P-5 Release would disclose confidential advice between the President and his advisors, or between such advisors [(a)(5) of the PRA]
P-6 Release would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy [(a)(6) of the PRA]

C. Closed in accordance with restrictions contained in donor's deed of gift.

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Freedom of Information Act - [5 U.S.C. 552(b)]

(b)(1) National security classified information [(b)(1) of the FOIA]
(b)(2) Release would disclose internal personnel rules and practices of an agency [(b)(2) of the FOIA]
(b)(3) Release would violate a Federal statute [(b)(3) of the FOIA]
(b)(4) Release would disclose trade secrets or confidential or financial information [(b)(4) of the FOIA]
(b)(6) Release would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy [(b)(6) of the FOIA]
(b)(7) Release would disclose information compiled for law enforcement purposes [(b)(7) of the FOIA]
(b)(8) Release would disclose information concerning the regulation of financial institutions [(b)(8) of the FOIA]
(b)(9) Release would disclose geological or geophysical information

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